Spy Bot

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/61993720.

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Teen And Up Audiences

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F/M

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by yourfellowhuman

Summary

Bow has created the Alliance's first Spy Bot, sending it to the Fright Zone to infiltrate its ranks and collect information.

After it winds its way through Hordak's sanctum, it comes across the Princess and the Warlord, hoping to stay hidden from the two scientists to... varying success.

Notes

Like my other one-shots, this hopefully lines up with my larger fic Freedom Under the Etherian Skies/Where Do We Go Now?

It also takes place sometime between the season two episodes "Signals" and "White Out"

I hope you enjoy this fic!

See the end of the work for more notes

Bow let go of the breath he was holding as he screwed the last bolt into the small bot lying on the table infront of him.

Once he checked that everything was in working order, he sped down the halls of Brightmoon in the direction of Glimmer's room, startling some half-asleep guards.

"Glimmer! Glimmer! Glimmer," Bow called, pounding on her door.

Bow paused when he heard clattering in the Princess's room followed by Glimmer appearing in front of him surrounded by a cloud of glitter. The princess wore purple, silk pajamas with a peach-pink satin sleep mask resting on her forehead

"Bow," she heaved, "It is 3 AM-" she grabbed the archer by the shoulders. "What could possibly be this important!"

"I finished the spy bot we were talking about," he said slowly, holding up the newly constructed bot.

"Huh," Glimmer squinted as she looked at the bot. "Cool." Her head snapped back to Bow's face and she glanced at the bags under his eyes. "Get some sleep."

Glimmer disappeared in another cloud of glitter followed by the muffled sound of her landing on her bed.

Days later, after dropping off the bot at the outskirts of the Fright Zone, the little guy made it into the heart of the Fright Zone.

The bot was about six inches tall with a camera embedded in its shell. It also had five legs that scrapped against its metal hull and made a crisp clicking sound as it walked on the steel floors of the Fright Zone.

The Spy Bot scuttled through the winding halls of the Fright Zone, keeping to the shadows to avoid the soldiers on patrol.

Meanwhile, back in Brightmoon, Bow, Adora, and Glimmer sat infront of a medium-sized screen in Adora's bedroom. The archer held a small controller in his hand, and his eyes were focused as he piloted the bot across the Fright Zone.

"Adora left or right," Bow asked when the bot reached a fork in the hall, each hall equally dark and unwelcoming.

"I think Hordak's sanctum is on the left, so left."

"You think?"

"Hey, it's not like I went there daily," she protested. "Besides, most people avoid his place like the plague."

Deep within the bowels of Hordak's Sanctum, the little bot weaved his way through the cloning vats and heavy machinery toward two indistinct voices.

Just like the stories from their childhood, Hordak's sanctum was as foreboding as their imaginations said. The ceilings were high and the cool lights were sparsely hung, creating large shadows that added to the mystery of this place. Heavy machinery cluttered the area, creaking and bubbling, creating a near-hellish symphony of the Horde's progress.

After rounding its last corner, the bot's camera caught a tall figure in its lenses.

The tall man was quickly identified as the fearsome Lord Hordak of the Horde, who was leaning over a motherboard and poking at the sensitive technology with a tool, creating sparks in its wake.

"Try to get closer to him," Glimmer suggested, leaning toward Bow's ear.

“If I get any closer, he’ll see us,” Bow argued.

“AHAH,” a high-pitched voice exclaimed, causing Hordak, the bot, and its pilots to jump. The small bot turned to see a mass of lavender hair at a large monitor displaying a pulsing red dot on a map of the Northern Reach. “Hordak, come look at this!”

As the trio of Alliance members studied the pixelated map, Hordak slid off the pair of the blue-lensed goggles he was wearing and stood beside Princess Entrapta.

“Oh of course those two are working together,” Glimmer huffed, crossing her arms. “They’re probably-”

“Shhh,” Bow chidded. Glimmer looked at Bow indignantly before returning her eyes to the screen.

Unfortunately for Bow and the other princesses, once Entrapta changed to a more natural tone, they could not make out a word she or the Warlord was saying. So, Bow led the bot closer to the two scientists, trying to keep to the shadows as it half-hazard climbed up a leg of a table.

“In that case,” Hordak began walking toward his project from earlier, “I will gather some Force Captains and soldiers to retrieve the tech we require.”

“Well no offense, Hordak, but this tech is delicate, and I don’t think the random soldiers sent to get it will handle it properly,” she argued. “Why don’t I go instead.”

“Absolutely not,” he asserted firmly, “Entrapta, you are far too integral to this project for me to let you galavant across the Northern Reach.”

“Oh come on, I doubt it’s that bad,” she disputed, dismissing his concerns with a wave. “I grew up in the mines of Dryl, if I can survive there, I can survive anywhere.”

“I severely doubt the Northern Reach is not a far cry from the likes of Dryl,” he retorted.

The trio watched as the two lab partners argued, neither budging from their respective stances. As the two bickered, Bow moved the bot closer and he didn’t notice Hordak’s ears starting to twitch as the metal pieces of the bot scrapped against each other.

Hordak took a slight step back, letting Entrapta fill the conversation, too distracted making her point to notice anything was amiss. Hordak kept his eyes trained on Entrapta as he listened to the entity scuttle in the shadows.

As quick as a whip, Hordak slammed his hand over the little spy bot, digging his talons into its metal shell. The sound of him slamming his hand on the bot echoed throughout the sanctum, stirring the failed clone that was sleeping up in the rafters.

Hordak’s sudden outburst managed to quiet the princess of Dryl, causing her to rise on her hair to look over the Warlord’s shoulder to see what looked like a heap of scrap metal under his claws.

“Now what do we have here,” he mused, looking over his shoulder. He then held the bot out infront of him, watching its legs flail.

“Oh! Let me see!” Entrapta almost reached out to rip it from Hordak’s hands but stopped herself before she could. “...please.”

Hordak tossed her the bot with a brief amused smile. Entrapta moved to sit on the table near Hordak, analyzing the bot while she made notes with her recorder.

Meanwhile, back in Brightmoon, the trio of friends were all, to put it plainly, freaking out as their ruse quickly came crumbling down.

“Well, it’s obviously some sort of spy bot,” Entrapta commented, poking at the internal wiring.

“I didn’t think anyone on the Alliance would think to create something like this,” Hordak added.

“Eh, it was probably Bow.” Entrapta guessed. “But it has a lot of design elements from my EKS droids, and I think this was made from parts of it too.”

“Ah,” Hordak mocked, “how original.”

“Hey,” Bow exclaimed, forgetting Lord Hordak was dozens of miles away.

“Bow,” Glimmer put her hand on the archer’s shoulder, “ I hate to tell you this but,” she gestured to a large red button on the controller, “I think we need to abort this mission.”

“Alright,” Bow accepted, heaving a sigh as he pressed the button.

Entrapta and Hordak were still picking apart the bot when it started to blink red and began to blare a harsh beeping sound.

Entrpata instinctively threw the bot into an emptier part of the lab while simultaneously pulling her mask down and covering her ears; meanwhile, after Entrapta launched the device, Hordak wound a protective arm around the princess and pulled her closer. When the bot hit the ground, it immediately exploded, launching flaming parts across the lab and leaving a black imprint on the steel floor.

While the remnants of the bots were producing clouds of smoke, the Princess and the Warlord pulled away from each other, the latter turning his head away from the former.

“Well, that was disappointing,” Entrapta lamented moving closer to look at the aftermath of the blast.

“At least we know the Alliance is at least attempting to advance their technology,” Hordak contemplated, as he watched Imp steal a piece of the demolished bot. “I’ll have to look into what this ‘Bow’ character is capable of.”

Entrapta gave no reply, staring at the smoldering pieces, clearly disappointed she could not fully study the Alliance's Spy Bot.

"While it might not fully compensate for the loss of the rebellion's tech, you could look at the Spy Bots I designed," Hordak offered, walking toward the scientist on the floor.

"You made Spy Bots…"

Entrapta smiled and shot up from the floor as she followed the Warlord into another part of the sanctum.

"I mostly used these bots when the last generation of Alliance members was in power and I was out in the field more," Hordak explained.

"How come they aren't used anymore?"

"They are still in use, just less so," he said with a shrug.

The duo walked a few more paces before Hordak began to ruminate on their conversation from earlier and an unexpected pang of guilt echoed in his chest.

Without warning, the Warlord stopped in his tracks and the Princess followed suit.

"Entrapta," he addressed, meeting her eyes, "I do not mind if you wish to retrieve the tech from the Northern Reach, but I implore you to take some mildly competent forces with you in case of emergency."

"Thank you, Hordak," Entrapta laughed and continued walking forward. "I'm glad you could finally see reason."

"Oh please," he taunted, "like I could keep you from going anyway."

End Notes

Something I'll hopefully have the inspiration for this year is more one-shots and other shorter fics.

Speaking of shorter fics, I'm planning to create a short, multi-chapter fic in time for Valentine's Day this year along with working on Entrapdak Positivity Month.

Anyway, thank you all for reading. I love you all (platonically).

<3

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!